

SNIPER ELITE®

ESCALATION

AN EXPANSION FOR THE GAME BY **ROGER TANKERSLEY** & **DAVID THOMPSON**

EXPANSION RULES



Creative Director and CEO: Jason Kingsley

Chief Technical Officer: Chris Kingsley

Publishing Director: Beth Lewis

Production Manager: Lewis Shaw

Game Design: Roger Tankersley & David Thompson

Solo Mode Design: Noralie Lubbers & Dávid Turczi

Development: Duncan Molloy, Anthony Howgego & Filip Hartelius

Additional Development: David Digby

Artwork: Edouard Groult, David Lanza, Ed Savage, Mark Ashcroft, Jo Painter & Ricardo Escovinha

Graphic Design: Brigette Indelicato, Pye Parr, Alysa Thomas & Lewis Shaw

Solo Playtesting: Giovanni Martinez

Copyright © 2026 Rebellion group. The Rebellion name and logo, and the Sniper Elite name and logo and the Sniper Elite eagle are trademarks of Rebellion and may be registered trademarks in certain countries. All rights reserved.

The stories, characters and incidents featured in this publication are entirely fictional.

Published by Rebellion Unplugged, Riverside House, Osney Mead, Oxford, OX2 OES, UK

Made in China

If any components are missing, please visit:
rebellionunplugged.com/contact-us

Sniper Elite: Escalation requires a copy of the *Sniper Elite* base game to play and can be enhanced further with the *Eagle's Nest* and *Operation Kraken* expansions.

ONE BULLET CAN CHANGE HISTORY

The war has reached a breaking point, each side amassing forces for a final push.

With everything balanced on a knife's edge, it's time to pull out all the stops.

The war will be won – or lost – today.

SPECIAL OPS

Sniper Elite: Escalation empowers players to customise each mission, with each side able to choose from a set of unique resources to bring to bear.

As the sniper, utilise specialised equipment, load up on all the gear you need to become a one-man army, and bring along a very good boy.

As the defender, secure the aid of elite officers, mobilise your defences to achieve battlefield superiority, and – if all else fails – call in the hunter.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

4 Components

6 Special Ops

8 Escalation Missions

12 Upgraded Loadouts

13 Extra Loadouts

14 Elite Specialists

16 Advantages

18 Appendices

20 Adv. Solo Mode

COMPONENTS



1 Good Boy Miniature



1 Hunter Miniature

PLUS...

1 White Action Cube

1 White Miniature Base (for Hunter)



5 Difficult Terrain Tokens



1 Deployment Zone Token



3 Flare Tokens



7 Advantage Cards



7 Upgraded Loadout Cards



6 Elite Specialist Cards



2 Sniper Escalation Mission Cards



2 Defender Escalation Mission Cards

SPECIAL OPS

The missions that were most crucial to the outcome of the war never made it into the history books.

Any game of *Sniper Elite* can be played as a Special Op, unlocking the new loadouts, specialists, escalation missions, and advantages in this expansion. This game mode is suggested for experienced players looking to add new challenge and variety to their games.

> **To use any of the contents of this box, you need to play a Special Op.**

1. Select Rank

Before setup, choose a rank from the options below.



Private: each side gets 1 edge.



Corporal: each side gets 2 edges.



Sergeant: each side gets 3 edges.



2. Select Map

Choose a map to play on.

If you are playing on the *Launch Facility, Submarine Pens*, or *Heavy Water Facility* map, the **sniper** chooses edges first.

If you are playing on the *Eagle's Nest, Super Carrier,* or *Norman Village* map, the **defenders** choose edges first.

3. Select Edges

The **sniper** chooses edges from the following list in any combination (including multiple of the same):



Sniper Escalation Mission Cards



Upgraded Loadout Cards



Extra Loadout Cards

The **defenders** choose edges from the following list in any combination (including multiple of the same):



Defender Escalation Mission Cards



Elite Specialist Cards



Advantage Cards

Escalation and advantage cards are announced as soon as they are selected.

Players choosing upgraded loadout cards, extra loadout cards, or elite specialist cards should announce how many of each they have chosen, but select these during the normal step during setup.

For example, if the sniper chooses to take an upgraded loadout card, they get to decide which specific one they pick after the defenders have chosen their edges, but before the defenders have chosen their specialists.

See the rest of this rulebook for rules on the new missions, loadouts, specialists, and advantages.

ESCALATION MISSIONS



In the chaos of war, things have a tendency towards getting… complicated.

Escalation missions modify the rules of the game to give your side an advantage. There is no limit to how many escalation missions can be used in a game.

> **When you choose an escalation mission, follow the additional setup instructions on the back of the card, then place it face up next to the board for reference during the game.**

SNIPER ESCALATION MISSION 1:

KILLSHOT

Two heads are better than one.

Setup

No additional setup is required.

Gameplay

When taking a shoot action, if line of sight is drawn through spaces with other defenders, the sniper may select one of them as a secondary target. Defenders with armour cannot be selected as a secondary target.

If the shot is successful and 0–1 recoil tokens were drawn, the secondary target is also removed. Add a token to the shot bag for the secondary target as well as the target.

If the shot is successful and 2+ recoil tokens were drawn, the sniper may choose to remove the secondary target instead of the target. If so, add a token to the shot bag for the secondary target but not the target.

SNIPER ESCALATION MISSION 2:

GOOD BOY

A very good boy is an elite sniper's very best friend.

Setup



Place the good boy miniature near the board.

Gameplay

Once per game, immediately before or after moving, the sniper may release the good boy. To do so, they mark a matching-adjacent space on the hidden board with a 'G'. The dog is now in that space.

On every future turn, the dog may move one space on the hidden board. Whenever it moves, it alerts defenders as if the sniper has made a noisy move. The sniper should not tell the defenders whether the sniper or the dog made the noise.

If the space with the dog is spotted or swept, reveal the dog and place the dog miniature there (but do not add any tokens to the shot bag.) The turn after it is revealed, the dog cannot move. The dog cannot be attacked.



This mission is loosely based on the true story of Rob the Dog, a heroic collie who served with the British Army during World War II. Originally a farm dog from Shropshire, Rob was adopted by the SAS and became a war dog, accompanying soldiers on more than 20 parachute jumps and several dangerous missions in North Africa and Italy. After the war, he was awarded the Dickin Medal (the animal equivalent of the Victoria Cross) for his service. He eventually returned home to his original owners and lived out his days peacefully.



DEFENDER ESCALATION MISSION 1:

FLARES

The most successful operatives thrive on chaos and confusion. The antidote is coordination and communication.

Setup

After choosing specialist cards, place a flare token on each specialist card.

Gameplay

Once on the defenders' turn, they may fire a flare. This does not cost an action (so can be used by a squad on the same turn that it gathers intel).

To fire a flare, choose an officer that has a flare token on its specialist card. Then, choose an open space in line of sight and up to 2 spaces away and place the flare token on that space.

At the start of the sniper's turn, if they are in an open space and within 2 spaces of a flare token, they must say so and add a recoil token to their bag. They don't have to say which space they are in. Then, remove the flare token from the game, regardless of whether or not the sniper was affected.

DEFENDER ESCALATION MISSION 2:

CALL THE HUNTER

Called on only in times of need, to see him is to be both bolstered by his presence and reminded of your own failures.

Setup

During setup, place the hunter miniature and the deployment zone token on the board as determined by which map it is, consulting the map diagrams at the back of this rulebook.

Place the white action cube on the "10" space on the countdown track.



Gameplay

The defenders have a fourth squad, consisting of one soldier: the hunter. Its actions are decided jointly by all the defenders. During the defenders' turn, this squad can take 1 of the following unit actions:

Move 2: Move the hunter up to 2 spaces.

Move 1 & Spot: Optionally move the hunter up to 1 space, then spot 1 adjacent space, adding noise to the sniper's bag if found.

Move 1 & Attack: Optionally move the hunter 1 space, then attack the hunter's current space, dealing a wound if the sniper is there.

Deploy: If the hunter is off the board, return him to the space with the deployment zone token.

Dismiss: Remove the hunter from anywhere on the board.

The hunter **cannot** gather intel.

Other squads can choose to call the hunter. If they do, they can't take actions or gather intel–move both of their action cubes to the next space on the countdown track. When the defenders call the hunter, the hunter may immediately take an action it hasn't taken this turn.

The hunter has armour 2, which means that in order to successfully hit him, you must draw 2 more aim tokens than you would normally require for a target in that space. That means you must always draw at least 3 aim tokens to hit the Hunter, even if you're attacking from the same space.

UPGRADED LOADOUT

For very special assignments, HQ can be surprisingly generous.

Upgraded loadout cards improve upon existing loadout cards.

When you choose an upgraded loadout card, immediately remove one copy of the card it upgrades from the game. If the upgraded loadout card replaces a card for which there are two copies, only remove one non-upgraded card.



Advanced sound masking lets you choose: move up to 4 spaces and alert defenders as normal, or move up to 3 spaces without alerting them.

Replaces: Sound Masking



Major distraction doesn't require line of sight, and you can now split the movement between two different units.

Replaces: Distraction



Modified tommy gun lets you temporarily add two aim tokens to the bag before shooting, making it more likely that your two shots hit. After finishing the shoot action, return both tokens to the supply (before adding any tokens to the shot bag).

Replaces: Tommy Gun

Panzerfaust lets you target an adjacent space instead of the space you're in.

Replaces: Trench Gun



Armour-piercing rounds lets you shoot into or through buildings entirely and makes it easier to hit, but doesn't turn noise tokens into recoil tokens. In addition, you get to draw a new (random) loadout card immediately after using it.

Replaces: Silenced Ammo





Trip mines will kill any soldiers in matching-adjacent spaces to where it's placed when it's triggered.

Replaces: S-Mine

Bayonet returns to your hand after use, and you can play a second loadout card after using it. You cannot play the bayonet twice on the same turn.

Replaces: Knife



EXTRA LOADOUTS



For each extra loadout taken, choose one additional loadout card during setup.

*For example, if you have **three** edges, and take **two** extra loadouts and **one** upgraded loadout, you'll start the game with **five** loadout cards, one of which is upgraded.*

ELITE SPECIALISTS

There are assignments for which you need the best of the best.

Elite specialist cards improve upon existing specialist cards.

> **When you choose an elite specialist card, immediately remove the non-elite version of that specialist from the game.**

Many elite specialists have a passive ability, shown in a gold band at the bottom of their card. Passive abilities have the following changes:

- You can use an elite specialist's passive ability every turn, even if you've used their normal ability.
- You can use their passive ability even if they've used their normal ability twice this game.
- You cannot use a passive ability if the matching officer is off the board.



Sennenhund, the Elite Medic, can use his ability to protect soldiers (but not officers) from other squads in matching-adjacent spaces. His passive ability gives him armour 2, which means that, to hit the Elite Medic, the sniper must draw 2 more aim tokens than they normally would.



Spürhund, the Elite Scout, lets the soldier he moved take actions the turn he moves them (as long as it's not an attack action). His passive ability lets you move a unit in his squad (which can be himself) when he gathers intel.



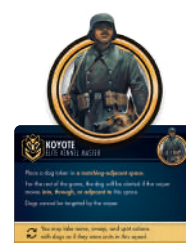
Kobra, the Elite Jager, can target a space up to two spaces away when when making an attack action, as long as the space is in line of sight.



Schakal, the Elite Radio Operator, can move before using his ability, but if he does, the deployed soldier cannot attack this turn. His passive ability lets you dismiss units from any squad without spending an action, though they can't be deployed on the same turn.



Adler, the Elite Sniper, can target a space up to three spaces away when he spots, as long as it's in line of sight.



Koyote, the Elite Kennel Master, can place dogs in matching-adjacent spaces instead of his own space, and the dogs are alerted if the sniper moves into, through, or adjacent to their space, even if it's normally a silent move. His passive ability lets you move, sweep, and spot with dogs as if they were units in his squad (spending the squad's actions).

ADVANTAGES

A little bit of foresight – or a healthy dose of paranoia – can tip the scales to your advantage.

Advantages modify the game to help the defenders.

> **When you choose an advantage card, place it face-up near the board.**

The Accelerated Schedule advantage can be used on any map. All other advantages can only be used on the specific map listed.



Map: Any Map

Accelerated Schedule means the sniper only gets seven turns to complete each objective. This is the only advantage that can be used on any map.



Map: Super Carrier Only

Tipped Off lets you lock any two doors on the map after choosing specialist cards to help box them in. Requires *Operation Kraken* expansion.



Map: Submarine Pens Only

Rapid Response does nothing right away, but once the sniper has completed their first objective, you get to further worsen their shot bag, as well as replenish one use of each specialist. This is wasted for any specialist with both action cubes still on their card.



Map: Launch Facility Only

Roadblocks help you slow down the sniper by turning four entrances and one additional space into difficult terrain. The fifth difficult terrain token must be placed in an open space and cannot be adjacent to other spaces with difficult terrain, including the entrances and any printed on the board.



Map: Norman Village Only

Under Curfew adds the locked doors from the Super Carrier map. After choosing specialists, place the 11 door tokens on any doorways on the map, open side up. Units in vehicles cannot open or close doors. If this advantage is chosen, the sniper should add the bolt cutters card to the loadout deck before selecting cards. Requires the *Operation Kraken* expansion.



Map: Heavy Water Only

Mechanisation adds the vehicles from the Norman Village map. See the diagram overleaf to see which spaces are roads, and which are vehicle starting spaces. Requires the *Eagle's Nest* and *Operation Kraken* expansions.

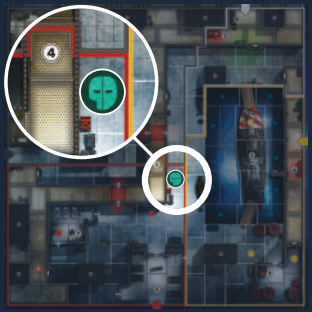


Map: Eagle's Nest Only

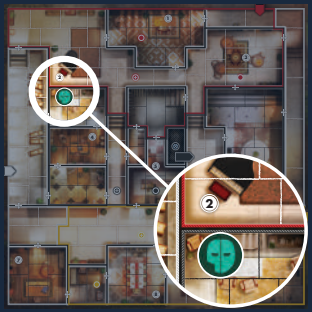
Sentries forces the sniper to disclose which entrance they used on the defenders' second turn. Remember that the sniper's objectives cannot be in the same sector as the one in which they started. Requires the *Eagle's Nest* expansion.

APPENDIX: CALL THE HUNTER

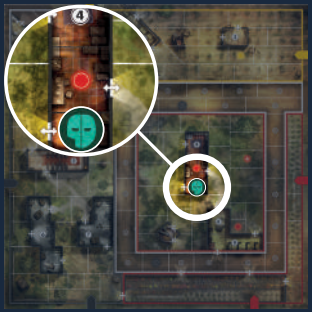
During setup, place the Hunter miniature and the deployment zone token on the board as specified for the selected map.



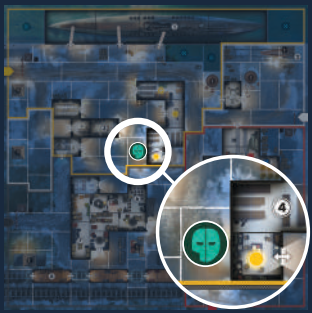
MAP | SUBMARINE PENS



MAP | EAGLE'S NEST



MAP | NORMAN VILLAGE



MAP | LAUNCH FACILITY



MAP | HEAVY WATER



MAP | SUPER CARRIER

APPENDIX: MECHANISATION: HEAVY WATER MAP

Vehicles start the game on the icons.

icons indicate spaces onto which the vehicles can move.



ADVANCED SOLO MODE

For the most experienced snipers, use the following challenges to intensify the difficulty on any solo mission. You can pick which challenge to add, or, if you're feeling brave, you can use them both.

Challenge 1: Shoot to Kill

Whenever you take a hit, take the top 2 tokens from your health stack and add them to your shot bag (instead of just one token). This applies regardless of the source of the hit. You can still take at most 3 hits on the same turn, but that is all 6 tokens.

If you take a hit while the health stack has only 1 token, add it to your shot bag, then become wounded. As normal, immediately remove three recoil tokens from your bag to form a new health stack, and ignore any further hits that turn.

If you take a hit while the health stack has no tokens, become wounded. Only remove two recoil tokens from your bag to form a new health stack, and ignore any further hits that turn.

Challenge 2: Rapid Deployment

Whenever a solo cards directs you to deploy a unit, that unit immediately scans. This means that, after a unit deploys in a space adjacent to the sniper, immediately take a hit.

Overkill

If the defenders still don't offer enough resistance, you can challenge yourself by using all the following modifications:

- Use the Shoot to Kill challenge above.
- Use the Rapid Deployment challenge above, but each defender **searches** when they are deployed, instead of scanning.
- Shuffle the specialist cards and draw 2, then use the complications from their officer challenges during the game.